

General Guidelines for Source Analysis

Historical context	Messages	Usefulness	Perspectives	Evaluate the extent
Explain the historical context	Compare and contrast the messages	Evaluate the usefulness of Source ____ as representatives of...	Identify and discuss the authors' perspectives in Source on...	Evaluate the extent which the four sources give an accurate insight into...
This question is concerned with the historical context in which the source is located. The answer must concentrate on what is in the source- explain the relevance/significance of the source content to the context. To do this: - Identify the focus of the source - Outline the causes or events that lead to the focus of the source - Provide specific details for the focus of the source – • Events • People • Ideas • Place • Dates • Students are expected to show depth and breadth of knowledge of the period and how the specific context/s relate to that broader period of study. • What was happening at the time the source was created?	Look for the message of each of the sources. To do this: - Read all of the elements of the source (title/author/date/location) - Identify the issue/event/subject - Identify the representation or opinion being expressed - Provide evidence from the source to support the response. Explain how they compare (are similar) and contrast (are different). A strong response will integrate the comparison and contrast with the discussion of the message/s. - Students are expected to show depth and breadth of knowledge when discussing the significance of the messages. - Show more than one point of comparison and of contrast. - Meaning of source - What is the author of the source saying?	Note the last part of the question: <i>as</i> representations of... Therefore, students must consider the usefulness of the sources in terms of the theme/force of the document study. Does the source assist in understanding what is being represented? To do this: - Consider the accuracy of the source - Consider the information in the source and question the reliability of the source type - Identify the discourse - Evaluate – make an on-balance judgement about the usefulness of the source as representations of the theme/force - Use evidence from the sources to support the on balance judgement. This will include the factual information such as dates/events/people - Consider the limitations of the sources: propaganda/gaps AND omissions/relevance/other perspectives - Strong responses will evaluate the usefulness of the sources as a pair rather than individually. - Is the source bias? - Is the source/site trustworthy? - Who is the author?	Note the last part of the question: <i>on...</i> Therefore, students must consider the perspective of the sources in terms of the theme/force of the document study. To do this: - Articulate the perspectives from which the source was constructed or analysed - Reasons for the perspective (purpose/motive/place/and time) - Provide evidence of the perspective from the source - Identify how the author shows the perspective in the source	Note the last part of the question. To do this: - Develop an opening statement which provides a thesis/proposition - Do not reiterate what is in the sources – this has occurred in the earlier questions - Make incidental reference to sources only – indicate, in brackets, where the cohesive or divisive impact being referred to is located (ed. S1, S4 and S5) - Equally, it is not only about omissions. - Focus on: - cohesive impact - divisive impact - omissions - evaluation